

THE JUICE OF AN ORANGE

P.G.WODEHOUSE

VI. Comment upon these statements.

1. Drioli went into the gallery because he was cold and miserable rather than because he was moved by love for Soutine and recollection of the past.
2. Drioli was suspicious of the gallery owner and fully trusted the tall man.
3. Drioli accepted the tall man's proposal because he was driven to despair. He did not realize what lay behind it.
4. Drioli died a natural death.
5. Art is something that has nothing to do with big business.

VII. Discussion. Critical thinking.

Discuss these questions in pairs, small groups, or as a class.

1. Drioli was affected by the war, wasn't he? Can you say whether many people were affected by the war in one way or another?
2. Why was Soutine unhappy about life? He knew he was a good artist, didn't he?
3. Do you think Drioli's sad end was inevitable? Can you explain why? Speak on social aspects of the problem.
4. What life do many young artists live in the world before their fame is established?
5. Speak on the problem of unemployment and its effect on people.

VIII. Give a summary of the facts of the story. The following phrases may be helpful.

The story introduces us to the events...; the attraction of this story lies in the fact that...; we might as well mention here...; among other things... the end of the story is suggestive enough because...

P. G. Wodehouse

Biography

What's surprising is that P. G. Wodehouse (1881-1975), the greatest comedy writer English language has seen, is virtually unknown to our reading circles.

PELHAM GRENVILLE WODEHOUSE, (to friends - Plum) (b. Oct. 15, 1881, Guildford, Surrey, SE Eng.- d. Feb. 14, (on St. Valentine day), 1975, Southampton, N.Y., U.S.)

Wodehouse received his education at Dulwich College, where he was a member of the school cricket team, (he would not lose interest in the local cricket tournament until many years later!) Also he practised boxing there. In this period he met gentry-folk which would serve as the main characters of his many books later.

Then he worked for two years for the Hong Kong and Shanghai Bank, (he got the place through his father's friends), but he left to earn his living as a journalist and storywriter. He sent his stories to many papers and magazines.

At 21, (1902), he started in the 'By the Way' column in the old Globe. Also he kept on sending his freelance stories and contributed a series of school stories to a magazine for boys, the Captain, (in one of which Psmith made his first appearance).

At the age of 28, not a long time before First World War, (1909), he went to America, (that was his second visit; his first had been in 1904) where he continued to write short stories and also critical reports for papers as theatrical critic. He made a serial for the Saturday Evening Post, (and for the next twenty-five years almost all his books make its first appearance in this magazine).

At that time Wodehouse met people close to musical circles, and wrote lyrics and took part in the creation of musical shows. At the same time he did not abandon writing and wrote Psmith, Journalist (1912), Piccadilly Jim (1918).

At the age of 33, (1914), he married.

During the next few years Plum travelled with his shows and chose as his country of residence - France. (He lived alternately in the UK and the USA until 1934, when he started living in France.) 1930 - 1935 he lived near Cannes. (PGW rented a house near Cannes in March 1932 but he settled in Le Touquet in 1934.)

In 1939 for services to the English language he received a doctor's degree from Oxford University.

In the beginning of World War Two he was pursued by the French government during "spy hunts". And when Nazi troops occupied France he was captured and interned in Germany.

After the war Plum continued to write books and took part not only in creating lyrics for musical comedies but tried his hand as a producer, (with differing degrees of luck).

In the early 1930s he was in the bad books of the Inland Revenue, (they could sue him for £25,000).

In 1955 (at the age of 74) all his problems were over and he took American citizenship and lived afterwards near New York surrounded by his Pokes.

In 1975 he was knighted by the Queen of Great Britain, and died shortly afterwards.

Wodehouse plots are about the idle rich in Edwardian England, where the worry-of-the-day in the life of a protagonist may be an impending visit from a ferocious aunt. Money changes hands over whose uncle is fatter, or whose infant is uglier, and what's more, such competitions are rigged!

Wodehouse is hardly ever included in the "literature" category, perhaps for the reason that his themes (thankfully!) lack the seriousness and gravity expected of literary writers. For the cognoscenti, however, the whole point about Wodehouse's writing is his superlative use of the English language. You read his prose, all perfectly plane English, and then you swear you'd never have come up with quite so amusing way of putting it.

We will go as far as to say that after Shakespeare, Plum is the greatest celebration of the English language, and that Wodehouse's prose is better than the best poetry ever written.

MONKEY BUSINESS

(P. G. Wodehouse)

(1) Mr Mulliner looked up from his Scotch and lemon¹.

"Strange," he said as the conversation in the bar had turned to the subject of physical courage, "how even in these civilized days women still admire heroism in the man. Offer them wealth, brains, looks, skill at playing the ukelele... unless these are accompanied by physical courage they will turn away. I was thinking of a cousin of mine, Montrose Mulliner, who had nearly lost the hand of Rosalie Beamish because of a gorilla."

"Gorilla?" said his companion, puzzled.

(2) "Yes," said Mr Mulliner. "Montrose was an assistant-director in the Motion Picture Corporation² of Hollywood: and the gorilla was one of the cast of the super-film, "Black Africa". He would never have thought to approach its cage and look at it if Rosalie, one of the extras, had not asked him to do so. As they were engaged to be married her word of course, was law; so he accompanied Rosalie to the animal's head-quarters.

(3) This is how it was.

Arriving at the cage, they found Captain Jack Fosdyke there, poking at the gorilla with a stick.

He was engaged to supervise the production of "Black Africa".

4. Richardson persuades Warrender to surrender the agreement with Howden.

VI. Discuss these statements or express your opinion on them.

1. A deal like the one Howden and Warrender made was a natural thing for both politicians.

2. Richardson came to Warrender on a mission he was reluctant to put through (выполнить).

3. Business and politics often cooperate closely.

4. Blackmail is common in politics.

VII. Give the main points of the story. Use phrases from Exercise VII of the previous stories. In addition the following phrases may be helpful.

Later the action develops...; the action moves on to...; it becomes obvious that...; the crucial moment comes when...; it's only human to expect...; he breaks down completely...; the title of the excerpt shows that...; it proves that...

THE JUICE OF AN ORANGE

(P. G. Wodehouse)

I

(1) "Speaking about dieting," Mr Mulliner said, "it is so excellent from a physical standpoint, and at the same time it may lead to complications. And yet, I have known great happiness result from dieting. Take, for example, my distant relative, Wilmot. Here's his story.

Wilmot was in high spirits that morning. He went about the Hollywood studio thinking hard as to how he could make his friends' life better. And when Mr Schnellenhamer called him to his office Wilmot's main thought was that he hoped that his boss was going to ask some little favour of him, because it would be a real pleasure to him to oblige.

He found the head of the Corporation looking serious.

"Times are hard, Mulliner," said Mr Schnellenhamer. "We'll have to do some salary-cutting."

Wilmot was worried. It seemed to him awful.

"Don't dream of cutting your salary, Chief," he urged. "You're worth every cent of it. Besides it may cause alarm. People will go about saying that things must be in a bad way."

"I was thinking of cutting your salary," said Mr Schnellenerhamer.

"Oh, mine?" cried Wilmot cheerfully. "Ah, that's different. That's another thing altogether. Yes, that's certainly an idea. If you think it will be of assistance and help to ease matters for all these dear chaps on the lot, by all means cut my salary. About how much were you thinking of?"

"I thought if we said seven hundred and fifty from fifteen hundred."

"It's an awkward sort of sum," said Wilmot doubtfully. "I would suggest five hundred."

"Or four?"

"Of course," said Wilmot. "Of course. Well, I'm delighted if I have been able to do anything in my humble way to make things easier for you², Chief. It has been a real pleasure."

(2) And with a merry "Tra-la" he left the room and made his way to the commissary, where he had arranged to give Mabel Potter, his fiancée, lunch.

She was a few minutes late in arriving, and he understood that she had been detained on some matter by Mr Schnellenerhamer, whose private secretary she was. When she arrived she said abruptly.

"What is all this I hear from Mr Schnellenerhamer?"

"I don't quite understand," said Wilmot.

"About your taking a salary cut."

"Oh, that, I see. Yes," said Wilmot, "Mr Schnellenerhamer sent for me this morning, and I found him very worried, poor chap. There is a world-wide money shortage at the moment, you see. So I've reduced my salary. It has eased things all round."

Mabel's face was stony.

"Has it?" she said bitterly. "Well, let me tell you that, as far as I'm concerned, it has done nothing of the sort. You have failed me, Wilmot. I have been disappointed in you. I think that we had better consider our engagement at an end."

Wilmot didn't expect it.

"You do not agree with me?" he asked in surprise.

"No. You are at liberty to make arrangements elsewhere."

"Of course," she went on more gently, "if one day you prove yourself worthy of my love, that is another matter. Just show me that you are a man among men."

(3) The effect of this on Wilmot Mulliner may readily be imagined. It had never occurred to him that Mabel might take things in this way. Life, felt Wilmot, was very difficult.

There seemed to Wilmot Mulliner nothing that he could do.³ He went into the commissary, and, taking a table at some distance from the one where Mabel sat, ordered Hungarian goulash, salad, two kinds of pie, ice-cream, cheese and coffee. For this misfortune seemed to sharpen his appetite.

And this was so during the days that followed. He found himself eating a good deal more than usual, because food seemed to lessen the pain at his heart.

The advice all good doctors give to those who have been disappointed in love is to eat lightly. Fail to do this, and the result is most dramatic. Wilmot for the first time in his life was forced to consult a physician. And the one he selected was a man of radical views.

(4) "On rising," he told Wilmot, "take the juice of an orange. For luncheon, the juice of an orange. And for dinner the juice" — he paused a moment before delivering the big surprise — "of an orange. For the rest, I am against eating between meals, but I think that, if you become weak during the day — or possibly the night — there will be no harm in your taking... well, yes, I really see no reason why you should not take the juice of — let us say — an orange."

"How about steaks?" asked the surprised Wilmot.

"Most decidedly no steaks."

"Chops, then?"

"Absolutely no chops."

"But the way I understand it you're suggesting that I live on orange-juice alone." "On the juice of an orange," corrected the doctor.

II

(5) It was some four days later that Mr Schnellenthaler was informed that Mr Eustiss Vanderleigh desired to see him. A playwright, this

Vanderleigh, of the Little Theatre school, who recently came to Hollywood among other playwrights.

"What does he want?" asked Mr Schnellenhamer.

"Probably got trouble of some kind," said Mr Levitsky, his companion. "These playwrights make me tired. One sometimes wishes the old silent days were back again."

"Well, send him in," said Mr Schnellenhamer.

Eustiss Vanderleigh was a dignified young man with tortoiseshellrimmed spectacles and flowing front hair. His voice was high and plaintive.

"Mr Schnellenhamer," he said, "I wish to know what rights I have in this studio."

"Listen..." began the Chief.

Eustiss Vanderleigh held up a slender hand.

"I do not mean my treatment as an artist. With regard to that I have already said my say.⁴ But there is a limit, and what I wish to ask you, Mr Schnellenhamer, is this: Am I to be hit over the head with crusty rolls?"

"Who's been hitting you over the head with crusty rolls?"

"One of your executives. A man named Mulliner. The incident to which I refer occurred to-day at the luncheon hour in the commissary. I was entertaining a friend at the meal, and, as he seemed unable to make up his mind about his meal, I began to read aloud to him the various items on menu. I had just mentioned roast pork with boiled potatoes and cabbage and was about to go on to Mutton Stew, when I felt a violent blow on the top of the head. And turning I saw this man Mulliner with a roll in his hand and on his face the look of torment. When I asked him about his motives for the blow, he merely muttered something which I understood to be "You and your roast pork," and went on sipping his orange-juice – a drink of which he appears to be especially fond, for I have seen him before in the commissary and he seems to take nothing else. The question to which I want an answer is this: How long is this going on?"

Mr Schnellenhamer moved uneasily.

"I'll look into it."

(6) The playwright left.

"Something'll have to be done about this Mulliner," Mr Schnellenhamer said. "I don't like the way he's acting. And if it goes on

I'll know what to do about it. There's no room in this corporation for fellows who sit around hitting playwrights with crusty rolls."

"No, there you go too far," said Mr Levitsky. "Playwrights ought to be hit with crusty rolls."

(7) Meanwhile, unaware that his orange-juice was in danger, Wilmot Mulliner was sitting in a corner of the commissary, looking gloomily at the glass which had contained his midday meal. He had fallen into a deep thought.

In the brief address, the doctor had told him about the spiritual uplift which might be expected to result from an orange-juice diet.⁵ The juice of an orange, according to him, was not only rich in the essential vitamins but contained also mysterious properties which improved one's spirits.

And now, as we have seen, the exact opposite had proved to be the case.⁶ Now Wilmot Mulliner had begun to look on his fellowmen with hatred. His ready smile had become a sneer. And as for his eye, once so kindly, it could have belonged to a man-eating shark and no questions asked.

(8) At two o'clock he was due in Mr Schnellenhamer's office, to attend a conference. He thought of Mr Schnellenhamer with distaste. He was feeling that, if Mr Schnellenhamer started to order him about, he, Wilmot Mulliner, would know what to do about it.

In these circumstances it should be noted that Mr Schnellenhamer had missed his lunch that day owing to the numerous duties, and he had ordered a plateful of sandwiches to be placed upon his desk.

It was not at once that Wilmot noticed the hateful objects. For some minutes he thought only about the conference. Mr Schnellenhamer was criticizing a point that had arisen in connexion with the scenario.

He paused in his speech and looked about him like a hostess collecting eyes at a dinner-party. And with a satisfied air he reached out and started eating a sandwich.

The effect on Wilmot Mulliner was tremendous. As I say, he had not been aware that there were sandwiches among those present and the sudden and unexpected sound of eating went through him like a knife. An angry light had come into his eyes, and he sat up in his chair.

The next moment those present were shocked to see him jump to his feet, his face red with anger.

"Stop that!"

Mr Schnellenhamer gave a start. His jaw and sandwich fell.

"Stop it, I immediately!"
He paused
risen and was
note of a siren

(9) One
among the D
the temperan
Public's wo
find at least
men trembl

At the
Burwash.
no nonsen

At tha
blood-str
she's got

"A sv

"She

Well, g

Pan

Mabel

throug

(10

occup

dark

her h

"

V

a re

had

oc

W

"Stop it, I say!" shouted Wilmot. "Stop eating those sandwiches immediately!"

He paused breathing hard with emotion. Mr Schnellenhamer had risen and was about to say "You are fired!" when he heard the sharp loud note of a siren. He knew only too well what that sound meant.

III

(9) One of the things which places the making of motion pictures among the Dangerous Trades is the fact that it is impossible to get rid of the temperamental female star. There is a public demand for her, and the Public's word is law. The consequence is that in every studio you will find at least one female star, at the mention of whose name the strongest men tremble.

At the Corporation in question this position was held by Hortensia Burwash. So that loud sound meant that she was angry and would stand no nonsense⁷.

At that moment the door opened and a young assistant director with a blood-streaked face cried: "Save yourselves! She's heading this way and she's got a sword."

"A sword?" Mr Schnellenhamer was terrified.

"She borrowed it off one of the Roman soldiery in 'Hail, Caesar'. Well, good-bye, all" said the assistant director.

Panic set in. In a few moments the room was empty except Wilmot, Mabel Potter, and Mr Schnellenhamer himself, who, too stout to get through the window, got into a cupboard.

(10) Wilmot didn't pay much attention to all this. His whole mind was occupied with hunger. He continued to stand where he was, as if in some dark trance. A woman with make-up on her face and a Roman sword in her hand rushed into the room.

"Ah-h-h-h-hl" she cried.

Wilmot was not interested. Hortensia Burwash was not accustomed to a reception like this.

"Ah-h-h-h-hl" she cried again and smashed a handsome ink-pot which had been presented to Mr Schnellenhamer by a few admirers on the occasion of the Corporation's foundation. Some of the ink had got on Wilmot's trousers.

"What's the idea?" he demanded angrily. "What's the matter with you? Stop it immediately, and give me that sword." The temperamental star lost some of her temper and looked at Wilmot. It seemed to her that she had caught a glimpse of something evil in his eyes⁸.

"I'm sorry about your trousers." She said miserably. "You wouldn't be so unkind if you knew what it was like."

"What what was like?"

"This dieting. Fifteen days with nothing but orange-juice."

The effect of these words on Wilmot Mulliner was stunning. His anger left him instantly. He started. He looked at his sister in distress⁹.

"You don't mean you're dieting?"

"Yes."

Wilmot was deeply moved. It was as if he had become once more the old, kindly, gentle Wilmot, beloved by all.

"You poor little thing! No wonder you rush about smashing ink-pots. Fifteen days of it! My God!"

"And I was upset, too, about the picture."

"What picture?"

"My new picture, I don't like the story."

"What a shame!"

"It isn't true to life."

"Tell me all about it. Come on, tell Wilmot."

(11) "Well, it's like this. I'm supposed to be starving, and they want me to write a letter to my husband, forgiving him and telling him I love him still. The idea is that I'm purified by hunger. And I say it's all wrong."

"All wrong?" cried Wilmot. "You're right, it's all wrong. I never heard anything so silly in my life. A starving woman's heart wouldn't soften."

"That's just how I feel."

"As a matter of fact at a time like that a female would be thinking of roast pork..."

"... and steaks..."

"... and chops..."

"... and chicken..."

"Of everything, in a word, but the juice of an orange. Tell me, who was the half-wit who thought of this story, so absolutely foreign to human psychology?" said Wilmot.

"Mr Schnellenhamer. I was coming to see him about it."

"I'll have a word or two with Mr Schnellenhamer. We'll soon have that story fixed. But what on earth do you want to diet for?"

"I don't want to. There's a weight clause in my contract¹⁰. It says I mustn't weigh more than a hundred and eight pounds. Mr Schnellenhamer insisted on it."

(12) At this Wilmot crossed to the cupboard and flung open the door. The boss came out on all fours. Wilmot directed him to the desk.

"Take paper and ink, Schnellenhamer, and write this lady out a new contract, with no weight clause."

"But listen..."

"Your sword, madam, I believe?" said Wilmot, extending the weapon.

"All right," said Mr Schnellenhamer hastily. "All right. All right."

"And, while you're at it," said Wilmot, "I'll take one too, restoring me to my former salary."

"What was your former salary?" asked Hortensia Burwash.

"Fifteen hundred."

(13) "I'll double it. I've been looking for a business manager like you for years. I didn't think they made them nowadays. So firm. So decisive. So brave. So strong. You're the business manager of my dreams."

Suddenly Wilmot's eyes met those of Mabel Potter who was hiding behind the table. In her eyes there was something which he had no difficulty in diagnosing as the love-light. He turned to Hortensia Burwash.

"By the way, my fiancée, Miss Potter."

"How do you do?" said Hortensia Burwash.

"Pleased to meet you," said Mabel.

Wilmot, as became a man of affairs, was business-like.

"Miss Burwash wishes to make a contract with me to act as her manager," he said. "Take dictation, Miss Potter."

"Yes, sir." said Mabel.

At the desk, Mr Schnellenhamer had paused for a moment in his writing. He was trying to remember if the word he wanted was spelled 'clorse' or 'clorze'¹¹.

WORDS AND PHRASES

I

- (1) **complication** *n* осложнение
in high spirits в хорошем настроении
favour *n* услуга
oblige *v* делать одолжение
awful *a* ужасный
urge *v* убедительно просить
cause alarm вызывать тревогу
in a bad way в плохом состоянии
ease matters поправить дела
lot *n* студия
by all means *зд.* пожалуйста
(2) **awkward** *a* неудобный
merry *a* веселый
commissary *n* столовая
fiancée *n* невеста
detain *v* задерживать
abruptly *adv* резко
poor chap бедный малый
shortage *n* нехватка
case things *зд.* облегчить положение
fail *v* подводить, *зд.* разочаровать
engagement *n* помолвка
be at liberty *зд.* иметь право
gently *adv* мягко
worthy *a* достойный
(3) **occur** *v* приходить в голову
misfortune *n* неудача, неприятность
sharpen *v* усиливать, увеличивать
fail to do this *зд.* не сделать этого
physician *n* доктор
(4) **deliver** *v* *зд.* сообщить
harm *n* вред
chop *n* свиная отбивная

II

- (5) **playwright** *n* драматург
silent days времена немого кино

- dignified** *a* обладающий чувством собственного достоинства
tortoiseshell rimmed spectacles очки в черепаховой оправе
plaintive *a* жалобный
treatment *n* обращение
crusty roll черствая булка
executive *n* *зд.* работник
boiled *a* вареный, отварной
Mutton Stew тушеная баранина
violent blow *зд.* сильнейший удар
torment *n* страдание
sip *v* потягивать (напиток)
uneasily *adv* с чувством неловкости
(7) **unaware (of)** не подозревая
gloomily *adv* мрачно
essential *a* основной
mysterious *a* загадочный, таинственный
property *n* *зд.* свойство
spirits *n* настроение
hatred *n* ненависть
sneer *n* усмешка, ухмылка, оскал
shark *n* акула
(8) **distaste** *n* отвращение
order about приказывать, распоряжаться
plateful of sandwiches тарелка с бутербродами
hateful object ненавистный предмет
arise (arose, arisen) *v* возникать
collecting eyes стараясь поймать взгляд
with satisfied air с довольным видом
tremendous *a* огромный, потрясающий

among those present среди присутствующих
 give a start вздрогнуть
 jaw *n* челюсть
 (to) be fired быть уволенным
 sharp *a* резкий

III

- (9) get rid of избавляться от
 consequence *n* последствие
 tremble *v* дрожать
 in question о которой идет речь
 blood-streaked *a* исцарапанный в кровь
 sword *n* меч, шпага
 borrow *v* взять взаймы
 Roman *a* римский
 panic set in началась паника
 stout *a* полный, тучный
 (10) rush *v* зд. ворваться, вбежать
 accustomed *a* привыкший
 smash *v* разбивать
 ink-pot *n* чернильница
 admirer *n* поклонник
 miserably *adv* с несчастным видом
 stunning *a* ошеломляющий

(11)

instantly *adv* мгновенно
 start *v* вздрогнуть
 gentle *a* мягкий
 be upset быть растроеным
 what a shame как жаль, очень жаль, сочувствую
 starve *v* голодать, умирать от голода
 forgive *v* прощать
 purify *v* очищать
 silly *a* глупый
 soften *v* смягчаться
 half-wit *n* полоумный
 foreign to human psychology *n* чуждый человеческой психологии
 weight clause *n* пункт контракта, ограничивающий вес актрисы
 weigh *v* весить
 (12) fling (flung) open зд. распахивать
 on all fours на четвереньках
 extend *v* протягивать
 hastily *adv* поспешно
 former *a* прежний

NOTES

¹ We'll have to do some salary-cutting – to cut smb.'s salary (урезать зарплату).

² Well, I'm delighted if I have been able to do anything in my humble way to make things easier for you. – Я рад, если в силу своих скромных возможностей помог вам.

³ There seemed to Wilmot Mulliner nothing that he could do. – Wilmot realized that he could do nothing.

⁴ With regard to that I have already said my say. – As to that I have already expressed my opinion. (Я уже сказал, что я думаю.).

⁵ The doctor had told him about the spiritual uplift... from an orange-juice diet. – The doctor had told him that he would feel better spiritually if he continued an orange-juice diet.

⁶ and now, as we have seen, the exact opposite had proved to be the case – the diet failed to raise Wilmot's spirits.

⁷ ...that she would stand no nonsense – ...that she was not joking and that she would show everyone what was what.

⁸ It seemed to her that she had caught a glimpse of something evil in his eyes. – She understood that he was angry and he himself might do her harm.

⁹ his sister in distress – зδ. сестра по несчастью.

¹⁰ There's a weight clause in my contract. – There's a clause in the contract under which my weight is fixed.

¹¹ "clorse" or "clorze" = clause (пункт).

COMPREHENSION ACTIVITIES

I. Answer these comprehension questions.

1. How did Wilmot feel about his fellow-workers that day? 2. Why did he agree to have his salary cut? 3. How did his fiancée, Mabel Potter, take the news? 4. How did Mabel's words affect Wilmot? 5. What was the doctor's most valuable recommendation? 6. What were Vanderleigh's charges against Wilmot? 7. How did orange-juice diet "raise" Wilmot's spirits? 8. Why couldn't Wilmot concentrate on work in Mr Schnellenhamer's office that day? 9. Why was Mr Schnellenhamer angry with Wilmot at the conference? 10. What was Hortensia Burwash and what position did she hold at the studio? 11. Why was everybody horrified when they heard the assistant director's words? 12. Why was Wilmot not interested in the star's violent behavior? What was the effect it had on her? 13. How did Wilmot and Hortensia come to understand each other in the dieting business? 14. How did Wilmot handle Mr Schnellenhamer with regard to a weight clause for Hortensia? 15. How did Wilmot benefit by his brave deed?

II. Give Russian equivalents of the following key phrases.

To cut one's salary; world-wide money shortage; to be disappointed in smb.; to sharpen one's appetite; a man of radical views; to eat between meals; a dignified man; my treatment as an artist; to entertain a friend; there's no room for; according to smb.; it should be noted; to get rid of; a

Гримуе *Горлачев*
public demand for; panic set in; to rush into the room; to smash an ink-pot; to be true to life; foreign to human psychology; on all fours; while you're at it; the manager of one's dreams; business-like.

III. Find facts from the story to support these statements.

1. Hortensia Burwash was the temperamental female star which is a must for every studio.
2. In Hortensia Burwash Wilmot found a sister in distress.
3. Mabel Potter loved Wilmot Mulliner for his courage.

IV. Describe these episodes. Make use of phrases from Exercise II wherever possible. Comment on the episodes.

1. Wilmot has his salary cut.
2. Mabel considers their engagement at an end.
3. The physician suggests an orange-juice diet.
4. Mr Vanderleigh states his charges against Mr Mulliner.
5. Mr Mulliner is at a conference in the conference room.
6. Mr Mulliner meets his sister in distress.
7. Mr Mulliner gets the better of his chief.

V. Discuss these statements or express your opinion on them.

1. Wilmot accepted the doctor's recommendations quietly. He believed that dieting would improve his character, raise his spirits and change his position for the better.
2. Playwrights and stars are nice people, easy to get on with.
3. Dieting is very much in vogue (мода) nowadays because it is good for one's health.
4. There are different diets for people engaged in sports, manual or intellectual work.

VI. Give the main points of the story. Use phrases from Ex. VII of the previous stories.